

Planning a Getting-Started Guide to Standing Up a PMIS in Healthcare IT

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COMPONENT 1 · 15 PTS

Audience Profile

Who is this for?

Newly appointed healthcare IT project managers and PMO leads: someone who has just been asked to formalize project management inside a hospital or health system that has been running projects informally through spreadsheets, email threads, and verbal check-ins. They are usually the first person in their organization asked to answer how projects will be managed centrally, often after a delayed EHR module or a system integration that went over budget pushed leadership to demand more visibility.

What do they already know?

General IT project basics: running a meeting, tracking a task list, and working with vendors. Many have led individual projects successfully and are comfortable with technology. What they have not done is select or stand up a formal PMIS, justify a governance structure to hospital executives, or account for how healthcare-specific factors, such as regulatory compliance, clinical stakeholder buy-in, and maturity benchmarks like EMRAM, change what good project management looks like compared to general corporate IT.

What do they need?

A practical decision-making guide rather than a textbook: something that helps them weigh whether to build, buy, or adapt a PMIS, understand what a healthcare PMO actually does day to day, and report progress in language executives already use. They are filling a specific gap: they know project management in the abstract but not how it is actually practiced inside a health system.

How will they use it?

Mainly for decision-making, while actively drafting a proposal or business case for leadership, kept open in one tab and referred back to for specific sections rather than read straight through in one sitting. Secondly as a quick refresher once the PMIS is chosen and they need to explain the reasoning to their team.

COMPONENT 2 · 5 PTS

Format Choice

Format: Getting-started guide, organized sequentially.

I'm structuring this as a sequential how-to guide that follows the actual order someone moves through the first time they stand up a PMIS: get oriented, build the case, weigh the evidence, choose a tool, and report results. My audience is going through a real, mostly one-time decision-making process rather than returning repeatedly to look something up, so a guide that mirrors the order of that process fits their need better than a problem-first FAQ or an alphabetical reference document.

COMPONENT 3 · 20 PTS

Annotated Outline

Six sections, each mapped to one or two sources from the Project 01 collection.

Section 1

Getting Oriented: What a PMIS Actually Is

Establishes shared vocabulary and dispels the assumption that a PMIS is just project software, before any decision-making begins.

Project management information system (Wikipedia)

A Complete Guide on Project Management Information Systems (TechRepublic)

Section 2

Building the Case for a Formal PMO

Explains what a healthcare IT PMO does differently from a general PMO, then grounds that explanation in a real, currently operating example a reader can point to when pitching leadership.

Project Management Office in Healthcare Information Technology (PMI.org)

UI Health Care Project Management Office (University of Iowa Health Care)

Section 3

What the Evidence Actually Says

Distills survey and case data on which PMIS features and reporting practices actually improve outcomes, so later recommendations are grounded in evidence instead of opinion.

Project Management Information Systems Overviews (PMI.org survey)

PMIS as a Tool for Integrated Cost and Technical Oversight (ResearchGate, 2024)

Section 4

Choosing Your Tool: Build, Buy, or Adapt

Walks through the real trade-off between an open-source platform and a commercial vendor deployment using two actual examples instead of abstract pros and cons.

OpenProject (GitHub)

Parkview Health: Optimizing Project Investments with PPM (Planview case study)

Section 5

Reporting Progress the Way Executives Expect

Shows how to translate project milestones into the maturity-model language hospital boards already use, plus what a high-risk project type like EHR deployment specifically requires in reporting.

Electronic Medical Record Adoption Model, EMRAM (HIMSS)

EHR Deployment Projects: Best/Worst Practices (PMI.org)

Section 6

Learning From People Already Doing This

Rounds out the guide with practitioner voice: a first-person account from an award-winning healthcare PMO leader and a current snapshot of how major health systems are running large IT projects right now.

Healthcare Innovation: Keeping the Focus on Patients (Projectified Podcast, PMI)

The Year in IT at 10 Major Health Systems (Becker's Hospital Review)

Six of the eighteen Project 01 sources (the Houston and Coplan/Masuda books, the Coursera course, the ONC Health IT Playbook, the Optimum Healthcare IT video, and the PMC journal article) aren't mapped to a section above. They stay in reserve as supporting depth for Project 02 rather than forcing a fit into this six-section shape.

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